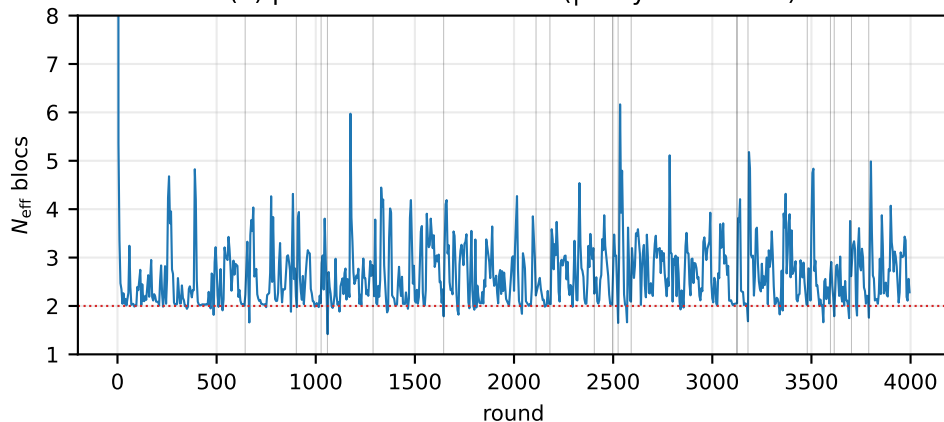
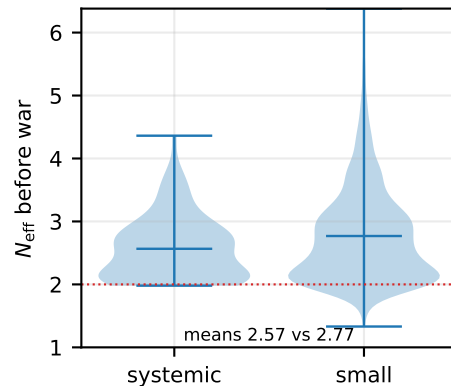


Option A: multipolar→bipolar transition precedes systemic war

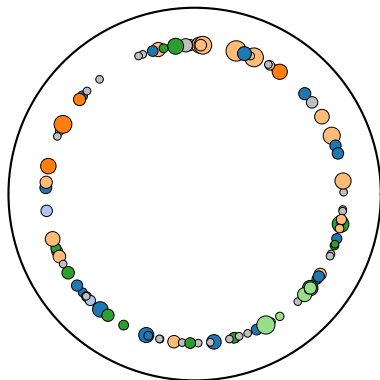
(a) polarization over time ($\mid$ = systemic war)



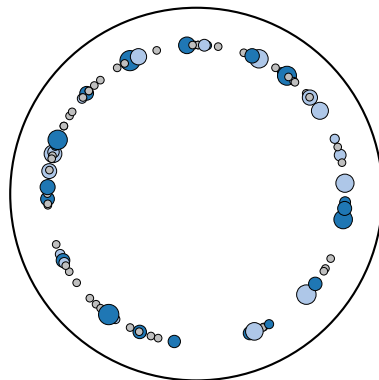
(b) bipolar precursor



(c) multipolar $N_{\text{eff}}=4.2$
(round 255)



(d) bipolar pre-war $N_{\text{eff}}=2.0$
(round 3175)



(e) severity vs polarization

